

Finger Pain - Male (Child)

Algorithm 1499 | Child (0-17 years) | Gender at birth: Male

Definition

- UAT-only adult and pediatric non-traumatic finger-pain pathway screening for infection, constriction and neurovascular compromise before in-person assessment.
- Child patient.
- Male.

Initial assessment

1. [LOCATION] Which finger, and where exactly?
2. [DURATION] How long has the pain lasted?
3. [YES_NO] Is the skin around the finger swollen and hot?
4. [OPEN_TEXT] What is the age; are rings constricting, is there systemic illness, wound/bite/nail infection, immune risk, hidden trauma, neurovascular change, pregnancy or child safeguarding concern?
5. [CAREGIVER_OBSERVATION] What has a safe parent or caregiver observed about alertness, breathing, pain, swelling, fever, eating or drinking, sleep, play, and normal activity?

Triage and redirect questions

1. Redirect → Motor Vehicle Accident

Did this joint problem begin with a motor vehicle crash or as part of a multi-system crash injury?

A motor vehicle crash or multi-system crash injury belongs in the Motor Vehicle Accident pathway.

1. Disposition level 100

Is finger pain severe with a cold/pale/blue/numb digit or constricting ring, or is there rapidly spreading redness/swelling plus marked systemic illness or deterioration?

Threatened digit circulation, a constricting ring, or spreading infection with marked systemic deterioration requires emergency assessment.

1. Disposition level 70

With no emergency feature, is there any persistent or unexplained finger pain, swelling, wound/bite, movement limitation, child concern or higher-risk context?

In-person assessment is required to exclude infection, tendon-sheath disease, occult trauma, constriction and neurovascular problems.

Advice

Qatar emergency finger/hand response

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 for an ambulance for rapidly spreading infection with systemic illness, severe pain, a cold/pale/blue/numb finger, or rapid deterioration; do not self-drive. Remove rings if easy before swelling worsens; do not force them off. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.
- Call Back If: increasing swelling or redness; fever or colour/sensation change.

In-person finger assessment

- Arrange in-person assessment for unexplained pain. Protect the finger and use wrapped cold briefly if comfortable; do not squeeze, puncture or use unapproved medication.
- Call Back If: pain, swelling or redness worsens; fever develops.

First aid

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 for an ambulance for rapidly spreading infection with systemic illness, severe pain, a cold/pale/blue/numb finger, or rapid deterioration; do not self-drive. Remove rings if easy before swelling worsens; do not force them off. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.

References

- NHS.UK, "Joint pain", <https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/joint-pain/> (page last reviewed 26 February 2026) - applied to non-traumatic finger pain

Provenance

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